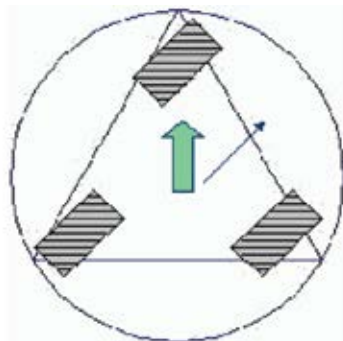
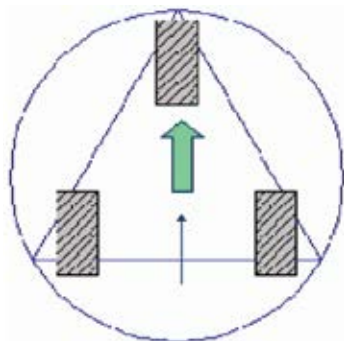




spend money on them at all.

There are a number of different papers, cardboards and foam-backed boards that could be used as part of a robot's structure; all you require is a bit of imagination. You may not have thought of this, but paper and cardboard which serve as packing materials for appliances are really strong and tough and thus are excellent materials for building your robots and different parts of them. Also, you won't require any sophisticated and complex tools like a drill or a lathe or welding machine, you can just do everything with a pair of scissors, a cutter, some glue and adhesive tape. The parts made from a piece of cardboard are much easier to ensure proper fit and clearances with other parts. Many people first make a prototype of the desired robot with cardboard and after they are done with it, they make the final robot with materials like wood or metals.

The only disadvantage to use cardboard as material for your robot is its ability to soak water and moisture, and this proves very critical if you are designing a robot which will traverse through wet or moist surfaces.

3.3.2 Wood

One of the most easily available materials for making robots, wood has always been the favourite for robot builders. There are many different wood varieties and products to choose from for use in a robot's structure and each one of them has its own characteristic feature that affect its suitability in different parts of the robot's body. The biggest advantages of using a wood are its ability to be worked using inexpensive hand tools like wood saw and also its fairly low cost. If you plan to use wood as a material to build the structure of your robot, you are advised to use the hardest woods available